God's Teeth is inseparable from the misery that made it. Stokes claims it was an attempt to write poison out of his troubled mind. Being a teacher is a dead-end career with more responsibilities than a job that carries a gun to back up its authority, truly a station that can drive one mad with helplessness. Frustration against the government, against your own incompetence, against those who were supposed to be guardians of your pupils, against the sheer lack of results, so forth. I would know. To me, God's Teeth has been perseverance in the face of overwhelming adversity. In abundance of pain in such surroundings, it was easy to make God's Teeth good, and to make it what it is.

In my own practice, God's Teeth was what I kept myself occupied with during some of the darkest times of my life. First episode, made in a place that I hate being born to with all my soul. Then it continues as I was completely alone in a foreign country with no residency, a few months' worth of savings and one last card left to play in my hand. Second episode, put together inside of a tiny motel room that was a drive away from the nearest cell tower, had to be hosted in an Airbnb. Finally, as this awful time of my life came to a close, so did the last of God's Teeth. Waiting, queues, food banks, social workers, other immigrants, frustration, these were the building blocks of God's Teeth.

I believe God's Teeth was first and foremost about *closure*. Stokes gets lost in the fleeting politics of Trump towards the tail end of his work. The implications of the monstrous universe he created far outdoes anything a federal agency that's a testament to incompetence like the ICE could ever do. Although Trump is a man who has never suffered from a single consequence in his life, I believe the events of the book could have taken place under different names, masks of institutions and pretenses. But there is only so much horror, real horror, that the human mind can handle before shattering beneath it. Trump administration and the equally worthless ICE are thus no more than a ridiculous bugbear.

The truth and nothing but the truth is revealed to your agents. Their world is over. There are no more mysteries to solve or falsehoods to uphold, and they lie dead. The story reached a conclusive and irrefutable end in their consumption by the universe, a rarified thing in literature. Them, and you, the player, arrived at this point by following your obsessions. You found out early that you were being roped into doing this, hurting innocents in the process. Yet you kept going. There was no meaning of "121" for you to find, for its meaning never existed in the first place. You made it up as you went. You killed anything and everything, and ruined when you couldn't, just to fill the hole in your heart. None of their pain was real compared to the sickly-sweet Truth. All that innocent blood was *worth it*.

But there is no such thing in the universe we live in. All there is being an eternal emptiness and longing which will quietly consume and digest all until the last man meets his end. You can close your eyes and pretend that it doesn't exist, and that human beings are a closed system that can survive forever without eventually inventing a God to adore. However, this is what truly separates us from animals. Not the hunger of the stomach, but the hunger of the mind. Without that, we are simply nothing.

Quororque, 10 October 2026